

Get Your Body and Bank Account Right This Summer EP 307

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jun 17, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5EZaF9YzXIA> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter lays out 3 concrete rules — track calories with AI, do focused 4-hour "one thing" work blocks, and time-block every hour in Google Calendar — to get ripped and increase income within 90 days this summer.

Detailed Breakdown

Intro & Context — Why Summer Is the Time to Act

- Brandon opens Episode 307 of the Victory Talk podcast, co-hosted/moderated by "Mo Novia DJ Chita Grande"
- Frames summer as a critical 90-day window — most people mentally give up by summer ("fuck it, I'll just be fat")
- Observed dads at a Disney cruise pool wearing shirts, points to this as a failure of standards men set for themselves in front of their kids
- The core argument: use the summer like the *ant*, not the grasshopper — the ants worked all summer while the grasshopper played, and the grasshopper died when winter came
- "Winter's coming" = the real-world consequences of wasted time arrive eventually
- Thesis: **3 rules** this summer will get you ripped AND rich simultaneously

Sponsors & Promotions

- **Free live online training** — Sunday, June 28th; topic: how to grow an online fitness business using AI; link in description; 100% free
- Brandon's credentials: made first million as an online trainer; "tens of millions" total; taught over **15,000 people** how to grow online fitness businesses
- Notable alumni: Austin Dunham, FedEx Fearless, Corey Armstrong
- **One-on-one online training** — second link in description; fill out application, respond to the automatic text message or Brandon will ignore you
- **"Thought Repellent"** — a joke/novelty spray product; target launch 4th of July if enough super chats come in to fund distribution
- **Victory Trades** — trade alert membership; Greg's daily options/futures alerts sent to your phone; live futures trading every morning

Rule #1 — Track Everything That Matters (Fat Loss)

- Most people who fail to lose fat are in *motion*, not *progress* — e.g., drinking smoothies that are 1,000+ calories while thinking they're eating healthy
- Key insight: **you can get fat eating healthy food** if you're not tracking calories

- Fat loss is pure math
- **1 lb of fat = 3,500 calories**
- **500 calorie deficit/day = 1 lb of fat lost per week** ($500 \times 7 = 3,500$)
- **1,000 calorie deficit/day = 2 lbs of fat lost per week**

Step 1: Track Calories Burned — Get a Wearable

- Wearable options mentioned: Apple Watch, Oura Ring, Garmin, Whoop
- Brandon's preference: **Oura Ring** — blends into all attire (works at weddings, workouts, casual); Apple Watch feels like "a big medical device"
- Whoop: looks like "spy kids" / "a cyber bully" under formal attire; fine functionally
- Samsung Watch: joked as effective vow of celibacy
- None of these are 100% accurate but give a usable range; you can calibrate over time
- Brandon demonstrated uploading an Oura Ring screenshot into Claude when the Apple Health sync was lagging, to get a corrected caloric burn figure

Step 2: Track Calories Consumed — Use AI Instead of MyFitnessPal

- Brandon used **MyFitnessPal** for over a decade but is now experimenting with **Claude (by Anthropic)** as a calorie-tracking interface
- ChatGPT also works; Claude's unique advantage: can be integrated with Apple Health data to read live burn stats
- How it works:
- Load a custom prompt (available by DMing Brandon the word "**tracking**" on Instagram — free)
- Throughout the day, type or photograph what you ate; Claude calculates macros, calories, and gives a running daily total
- Claude estimates portion size from photos when weighing isn't possible — Brandon tested this vs. weighed food and found it within acceptable range
- Can also photograph a food label image — Claude reads it automatically without a separate prompt
- Example: Denver omelette (4 oz, weighed), 2 oz salmon, vegetables at a catered event — all logged via text or photo
- Handles sauce nuance better than MyFitnessPal (e.g., "chicken breast with hibachi sauce" spoken naturally)
- Claude integration also shows *real-time deficit* for the day (e.g., current deficit of 561 calories mid-day)
- Brandon's daily example outcome: 2,500 calories consumed, 240g+ protein, carbs slightly over 50g (he's keto, aims under 50g)

Duke University Study — Why Mere Tracking Works

- Duke University found that subjects who *only* tracked calories on MyFitnessPal — no diet plan, no workout plan, same food — **lost an average of 5 lbs in 3 months**
- The mechanism: seeing your numbers makes you make better decisions unconsciously

"The mere act of tracking your calories — if all you did was track — you would lose weight."

- Brandon's 27-year training experience confirms this: every client who starts tracking is shocked by how many (or how few) calories they're eating

- Skinny guys who "can't gain" are often eating only 1,500 calories/day
- Overweight people who "tried everything" often have no idea of their intake

Simple Targets for Getting Ripped

- **Calories:** Body weight in pounds $\times$ 10 = daily calorie target for cutting
- Brandon = 200 lbs 2,000 calories/day
- **Protein:** Body weight in pounds $\times$ 1 = grams of protein per day
- Brandon = 200 lbs 200g protein/day
- Benefit for beginners (first year of serious training): can burn fat AND build muscle simultaneously (body recomposition); after years of training, the protein target mainly preserves existing muscle during a cut
- Diet is the most important factor — "you can't out-train a bad diet, but you can out-diet bad training"

Exercise Add-Ons (Optional but Effective)

- **Cardio:** 30–60 minutes of **steady-state cardio per day** — low intensity (conversational pace), e.g., walking, exercise bike, elliptical
- Brandon does this live on Instagram — answering questions while cycling; no high-intensity required
- **Lifting:** **3–4 full body workouts per week**; 1–2 exercises per body part; 3–4 sets each

Rule #2 — Stop Working on Irrelevant Things; Focus on the One Thing

- Common business mistake: spending months on logos, names, "figuring out where to start" — none of that gets you clients or money
- Framework source: **the book *The One Thing*** (author was worth hundreds of millions at time of writing, ~20 years ago)
- Core question from the book: *"What is the one thing that, if you accomplished it, would make everything else easier or unnecessary?"*
- Author's prescription: **work on that one thing for 4 hours per day**, focused, no distractions, notifications off
- Important caveat: watching YouTube, reading, and studying do NOT count toward the 4 hours — only actually doing the work counts
- Brandon's personal example: after reading the book, he focused on **content creation** 4 hours/day made his first million as an online trainer
- Content creation made "everything else easier or unnecessary" for growing an online fitness business
- The 4 hours does NOT have to be consecutive
- Example: 2 hours morning + 2 hours evening works for 9-to-5 workers
- It's an **average** of 4 hours/day — if you miss a day, make it up on weekends (6–8 hours those days)
- Weekly total target: 28 hours on the one thing
- **"If you do this, you will not fail."** — but almost nobody actually does it

Rule #3 — Live Out of Your Calendar (Google Calendar Time-Blocking)

- "I don't have time" is not a real problem — it's ineffective use of existing time
- Recommended tool: **Google Calendar** (the only calendar Brandon recommends)

- Two types of tasks:
- **Recurring tasks** — same time every day/week: sleep schedule, work hours, gym, meals, family time, commute
- **One-time tasks** — variable; scheduled in advance when they arise

How to Set Up the Calendar (Step by Step)

1. **Lock in sleep** — e.g., 10 PM to 6 AM, set to repeat *daily*; consistent sleep/wake times set circadian rhythms
2. **Lock in work** — e.g., 9 AM–5 PM, repeat every weekday
3. **Lock in commute** — e.g., 1 hour each way; Brandon notes that commuting over 1 hour is a lifestyle problem worth solving
4. **Lock in workout** — up to 1 hour; set to repeat daily; color-code it
5. **Lock in family time / date night** — e.g., Tuesday evenings; repeat weekly
6. **Lock in "One Thing" deep work blocks** — find remaining gaps; color-code purple ("mad important") - Example schedule he built live: weekday deep work blocks (Mon/Wed/Fri ~2 hrs each) + Saturday and Sunday 6-hour blocks = ~28 hrs/week average (~4 hrs/day)
7. **Eliminate white space** — "white space is the devil"; every open slot should have something assigned

Key Benefits of Living by Calendar

- Forces you to find 4 hours for the one thing — proves the time exists
- **Accidentally eliminates bad habits** — you won't schedule "Call of Duty weed smoking sessions" or "gooning," so they just stop happening
- Brandon's example: quit weed and alcohol ~11 years ago not by trying to quit, but by planning every hour — the bad habits simply didn't get calendar time
- Brandon's promise: everyone he knows who starts planning every hour of every day sees their whole life change within **90 days**
- Caveat: you'll miscalculate how long things take at first — keep adjusting, you'll get better

Excuses — Addressed

- **"I have kids"** — kids should be motivation, not an excuse; Brandon pushes back hard on dads who blame children for their fitness decline
- On the Disney cruise, he burned "crazy calories" swimming with dolphins, running around the boat, water gun fights at a barbecue — kids are a caloric advantage if you engage with them
- Trampoline parks, walks, active play = real calorie burn (track it on your Apple Watch)
- **"I have a girlfriend who cooks too much"** — your food choices are still your responsibility; example of a friend who got fat again after getting a girlfriend because he stopped caring once he was getting sex regularly
- Brandon's girlfriend cooks keto-aligned food and even weighs his portions for him — but even without that, "it's still your responsibility what you put in your mouth"

90-Day Summer Challenge Summary

- Track calories consumed and protein every day (use Claude + DM "tracking" on Instagram for the prompt)
- Track calories burned with a wearable

- Live out of Google Calendar — no white space
- Average 4 hours/day on your one thing
- Promised results: best shape of your life, more disposable income, more confidence, more respect from family and peers, more energy, longer life

Market Recap — With "Young Candlestick" (Greg, Series 65)

Overall Market Outlook (90-Day Forecast)

- Base case: **a whole lot of nothing** — not a lot of huge upside, not a lot of major sell-offs
- Market was oversold, bounced, now slightly overbought
- S&P 500: up big the prior day, small pullback at recording
- IWM (small caps): stair-stepping higher but possibly forming a **rising wedge** — Greg and Brandon agree the bearish case is hard to argue against
- Key level: if IWM loses its prior all-time highs, that would be bearish
- Semiconductors: down 5% on a single day after a big run; may see further weakness over coming weeks possible market-wide downside signal

Key Stocks & Trades Discussed

- **NBIS (Nebius)** — AI data centers; being added to NASDAQ 100 and QQQ (bullish catalyst)
- Previously highlighted near \$215; now near all-time highs (~\$278)
- Up **210% year to date**; Greg thinks "it's just getting started"
- Next actionable setup: buying the all-time high breakout above \$278
- **Crude oil / energy** — sold off hard after Trump's peace deal; technical chart looks like a rounding top; Greg thinks oil could get as low as **\$60/barrel** but sees that as a buy-the-dip opportunity
- Neither expects gas prices to sustainably go below **\$3/gallon** unless widespread shift to EVs
- **Bitcoin** — lower lows, dead cat bounce; "really just nothing"
- **VIX (volatility/fear index)** — big spike then recovery; forming a small bottom, which could signal short-term market weakness
- **SpaceX (SPCX)** — IPO'd; stock ran from **\$149 to \$225**; options now available but "stupidly expensive" due to high implied volatility
- Greg likes **selling bullish put credit spreads at \$175 into Friday** — risk ~\$450 to make ~\$50, ~90% probability of profit
- Potential gamma squeeze if stock breaks above all-time highs as OTM calls get bought up
- **Google (GOOG)** — up **20% year to date**; owns **7% of SpaceX**; Greg buying instead of SpaceX directly as a proxy; near highs but not at all-time highs
- **Microsoft (MSFT)** — "out of rotation," can't catch a bid; Greg bought at \$390, averaged up at \$400, still weak
- SpaceX surpassed Microsoft in market cap within its first 3 days of trading
- **Netflix (NFLX)** — bleeding since last earnings; Greg's fair value estimate: **~\$120/share** (implies ~50% upside from ~\$78), but trend is bearish; would wait for it to form a new chart base around \$85 before entering
- **Apple (AAPL)** — doing well, slightly off all-time highs
- **Meta** — stuck in consolidation, well beneath all-time highs

- **Caterpillar (CAT)** — industrial sector; breaking out to all-time highs; Greg highlights it
- **TSM (Taiwan Semiconductor)** — Greg's **favorite semiconductor stock**; building out large plants; price target: **\$1,000 in 3 years** (currently ~\$425); "reliably double your money"; pays dividend; Greg sells monthly bullish put credit spreads
- Speculation: Tesla, Twitter/X, and SpaceX may eventually merge under one ticker symbol "X"
- Elon Musk noted as becoming the **first trillionaire**

Fed / Macro Context

- FOMC meeting the next day with new Fed chair **Worsh** — no rate cuts priced in for the entire year
- New Fed chair wants to **raise** rates tougher borrowing, slower growth, but should gradually reduce cost of living
- Meeting acts like an "earnings report" for the market — expect a sharp spike up or down in reaction
- Iran peace deal: Trump deal potentially gives Iran access to **\$300 billion** vs. the Obama deal's **\$1.7 billion**
- Brandon frames this as a 200x increase; notes Trump previously criticized any financial benefit to Iran
- Greg: lower oil from the deal gives the Fed more room to potentially cut rates, though no cuts are priced in
- Day trading rules update: the **PDT (Pattern Day Trader) rule** is effectively gone for margin accounts — you may only need **~\$2,000** (not the old \$25,000) to day trade freely

Victory Trades Results Shown

- HIMS breakout trade (flat-top breakout above \$30): one member made **\$200** — "two months of Victory Trades paid for in one trade"
- Another trade: **\$99 into \$550** (455% gain)
- Simus: made **\$837 on a funded account** trading live
- GTMo: **\$245** gain
- Greg's same-day trades: scalped a 123% gain on a put (\$97 in \$217 out); took profits on copper; alerted a Google trade

Super Chat Q&A Highlights

Book Recommendation

- Listener asked for something like *Atomic Habits* but for mindset
- Brandon recommends: **"Awaken the Giant Within" by Tony Robbins**
- Strong caveat: **do not get the audiobook** — it's abridged/different content; read the physical book
- "It's in my top five books I ever read"

Caffeine + Bronade vs. Ozempic

- Listener Jesse went from 19% to near 10% body fat using keto, caffeine, and bronade; running 1,000 calorie deficit with no hunger
- Brandon's take: GLP-1 drugs like Ozempic mostly work by suppressing appetite — which caffeine + bronade already does naturally and more cheaply
- "Ozempic face" — occurs because the drug suppresses appetite so aggressively that people under-eat protein, lose facial muscle mass, and develop a gaunt, hollow look

Body Composition Question (Martin, 6'6", 265 lbs from 298 lbs)

- Has no definition except in traps; asking if it's body fat or insufficient lifting
- Brandon: it's body fat — definition comes from **low body fat percentage**, not just lifting
- Recommendation: cap at **3,000 calories/day**, up to **300g protein/day**; the belly fat is characteristic of where men store fat cells (abdomen vs. women's hips/glutes)

Weight Loss Timeline (Mike, 260 lbs 200 lbs by December)

- 24 weeks to December; needs to lose **60 lbs**
- Math: **1,000 calorie deficit/day = 7,000 cal/week = 2 lbs/week × 24 weeks ≈ 48 lbs**
- To hit 60 lbs: needs a larger deficit AND/OR add **one 24-hour fast per week**
- Key reminder: keto doesn't automatically mean fat loss — you still must burn more than you consume; Brandon himself gained fat on keto while bulking at **4,000 calories/day**

Trading Practice Advice (Stephen / Mike)

- Brandon's own path: practiced on **Ninja Trader** (simulated trading with downloaded historical data) for exactly **200 hours**; first payout from Apex Funded was **~\$50,000**
- Process: download historical data for specific sessions, set it to just before the open, trade the session without knowing what happened — pure skill practice
- Advice for Forex: same approach — download historical data for the specific pair and session you trade

Misc Personal / Cultural

- Disney cruise with his son: son said "I think today was one of the best days of my life" — Brandon compared the feeling to Jalen Brunson winning the NBA Championship
- Guitar: recommends **PRS Silver Sky SE** (budget version) over the standard model — essentially the same guitar at ~1/4 the price (~\$2,000 savings); got his modded with a pickup switcher flip that converts first two pickups into a humbucker
- Shoutout to commenter Andre (black guitar teacher with dreadlocks, PhD) who influenced that guitar purchase and is also losing weight (195 181, targeting 170) while building a guitar lesson business